■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Thursday, October 22, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■■ *In 1952, Royce Williams fought 7 Soviet MiG-15s alone for 35 minutes, downing three and damaging a fourth. His jet returned with over 260 bullet holes, but the battle was classified for 50 years. At 100, he received the Medal of Honor; at 101, Disneyland just named him an honorary citizen.*

The Angle: *A Cold War secret this wild stayed buried for 50 years, and now it's capping off with Disneyland making the guy an honorary citizen at 101 - this is the kind of real-life action movie listeners can't believe they're hearing for the first time.*

- **Royce Williams** took on **7 Soviet MiG-15s** solo for **35 minutes** over Korea in 1952
- He shot down **three** of them and damaged a fourth
- His jet limped home with over **260 bullet holes**
- The mission was classified for **50 years** before he received the **Medal of Honor at age 100**

The Jaw-Drop Moment

- Ask listeners: what's the most unbelievable secret a grandparent or relative sat on for decades before anyone found out?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://disneyparksblog.com/disney-experiences/disneyland-honors-medal-of-honor-recipient-royce-williams/

■ *Dota 2 Player Scores 32 Kills to Convince Police to Release His Teammates*

The Angle: *This is the kind of too-weird-for-fiction story that stops a scroll - a video game performance apparently doubling as a get-out-of-jail card. It's pure watercooler material: wild premise, instant 'wait, what?' reaction.*

- A **Dota 2** player reportedly racked up **32 kills** in a single match
- That performance was apparently enough to convince **police** to release his **teammates**
- Story's so bizarre it landed on **r/nottheonion**, where "too strange to be satire" stories live

The What-Did-We-Just-Read Moment

- Could you ever game your way out of trouble - and what's the wildest excuse that's actually worked for you?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.strafe.com/news/read/dota-2-player-scores-32-kills-to-convince-police-to-release-his-teammates/

■ *YouTube is testing hiding the dislike button entirely and users aren’t happy*

The Angle: *YouTube is testing hiding the dislike button entirely and users aren’t happy*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.dexerto.com/youtube/youtube-is-testing-hiding-the-dislike-button-entirely-and-users-arent-happy-3420822/

■ *Xbox wants you to pay 24 to 40 cents per hour to stream games you already bought*

The Angle: *Gamers are furious over reports that Xbox could charge a per-hour streaming fee to play titles you've already paid for — it's the kind of "wait, what?" pricing move that turns casual gamers into instant critics and taps into the bigger fear that nothing you "buy" digitally is really yours anymore.*

- Reports point to a streaming fee of roughly **24 to 40 cents per hour** of play.
- The catch: this would apply to **games you already purchased**, not new rentals.
- It's tied to **Xbox's cloud/streaming push**, shifting games from something you own to something you access.

The Debate Starter

- Would you pay by the hour to stream a game you already own — or is this the line where gamers finally revolt?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/gaming/2026/10/xbox-wants-you-to-pay-24-to-40-cents-per-hour-to-stream-games-you-already-bought/

■ *The DoD has loaned the Dept of Homeland Secuity a military 'Heat Ray' (Active Denial System) for use at the US-Mexico Border*

The Angle: *The Department of Defense is lending Homeland Security a military-grade 'Active Denial System' — basically a heat-ray crowd-control weapon — for use at the US-Mexico border, and that's the kind of 'wait, that's a real thing?' story that gets a whole phone line lit up.*

- The **Department of Defense** is loaning the **Department of Homeland Security** a weapon known as the **Active Denial System** — nicknamed the **'Heat Ray'**
- It's intended for deployment at the **US-Mexico border**
- The system was originally developed as a **military non-lethal crowd-control weapon**

The Debate Starter

- Smart deterrent or a dangerous escalation at the border — where do you land?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.military.com/dod-memo-greenlights-dhs-use-of-military-heat-ray-at-us-mexico-border

Backup options:

■ *Study identifies world’s first corporate psychopath. The same playbook we see in toxic workplaces today appears in this case from 1629. He removed opponents, rewarded loyalists, created fear, manipulated followers and pursued power at any cost*

The Angle: *A new study says the classic 'toxic workplace' playbook isn't a modern invention—it traces the same power-hungry, fear-based leadership tactics back nearly 400 years, which makes it an instant mirror for anyone who's ever survived a bad manager.*

- Researchers point to **1629** as the earliest documented case of what they're calling a 'corporate psychopath.'
- The tactics: **removed opponents**, **rewarded loyalists**, and **ruled through fear**.
- Study says the same figure **manipulated followers** and **pursued power at any cost**.
- The takeaway: the modern 'toxic boss' playbook is basically **400 years old**.

The Office Villain Checklist

- Callers: raise/removed opponents, rewarded yes-men, ran on fear—does that describe your boss right now?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1148675

■ *Carney government’s new immigration policy for foreign workers a tough sell to Canadians*

The Angle: *Immigration is one of the most divisive kitchen-table issues in Canada right now, and word that Prime Minister **Carney's** new foreign worker policy is facing public pushback plugs straight into the ongoing fight over jobs, housing, and cost of living.*

The Debate Starter

- Do you think Canada needs to pump the brakes on foreign worker visas right now, or is this policy getting blamed for problems it didn't cause?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thehub.ca/2026/10/21/carney-governments-new-immigration-policy-for-foreign-workers-a-tough-sell-to-canadians/?hubcta=home_free_row_analysis

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■ *Iron Maiden's Nicko McBrain rejected round of golf with Donald Trump: "Should be put in jail"*

The Angle: *A rock legend publicly torching a sitting-or-former president over a golf invite is the kind of celebrity-meets-politics collision that's made for radio - it's blunt, it's quotable, and it forces a take.*

- **Nicko McBrain**, longtime drummer for **Iron Maiden**, says he turned down an offer to golf with **Donald Trump**
- McBrain didn't hold back, saying Trump "**should be put in jail**"
- The comment is making the rounds as a classic rock-star-vs-politician soundbite

The Debate Starter

- Would you turn down a round of golf with a president just to make a political point - or play anyway and let your clubs do the talking?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://faroutmagazine.co.uk/iron-maidens-nicko-mcbrain-rejected-round-golf-donald-trump-jail/

■ *John Malone Says Trump Administration Told Netflix They Had "No Chance" Of Getting Regulatory Greenlight For Merger With Warner Bros. Discovery*

The Angle: *This is a massive media-and-politics mashup — a Netflix/Warner Bros. Discovery merger would've reshaped Hollywood, and now a Trump-world insider is saying the White House quietly torpedoed it before it even got a hearing.*

- **John Malone**, the billionaire media mogul and Liberty Media/Charter chairman, is the one making the claim.
- Malone says the **Trump administration** told **Netflix** it had "**no chance**" of getting regulatory approval.
- The deal in question: **Netflix** merging with **Warner Bros. Discovery**, one of the biggest potential shakeups in streaming history.
- Raises the question of how much political influence is steering who gets to buy who in Hollywood.

The Debate Starter

- Should the White House get a say in which streaming giants are allowed to merge — or is this politics muscling into Hollywood's business?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/10/john-malone-trump-netflix-warner-bros-discovery-1237169649/

■ *Ilhan Omar breaks her silence and turns to supporters for financial help as a federal investigation into her immigration history continues: "We know that they're running scared, we're not going to be intimidated, we're not going to be silenced, we're not going to be scared."*

The Angle: *A sitting member of Congress is under federal investigation over her immigration history right before the midterms, and instead of going quiet she's asking supporters for $5 and $10 donations while accusing the administration of trying to intimidate her — that's a split-screen story built for debate.*

- **Ilhan Omar** is under a **federal investigation** into her **immigration history**, timed right before the **midterm elections**
- She's publicly thanking supporters who sent **"$5, $10, $20"** to help her fight back
- Her quote: **"We know that they're running scared, we're not going to be intimidated, we're not going to be silenced, we're not going to be scared"**
- She says she'll be out **campaigning** to help **"win the House, win the Senate"**

The Debate Starter

- Is this legitimate federal scrutiny of a sitting congresswoman, or political intimidation timed to the midterms — where do you land?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/67thhh0artwh1

■ *Federal government to announce new funding for 60 national sport organizations: sources*

The Angle: *The feds are quietly topping up funding for 60 national sport organizations, and it's landing right as athletes everywhere are griping about being broke between Olympic cycles - that's a real 'where does our tax money go' conversation starter.*

- Sources tell **CBC Sports** the federal government will unveil the funding Thursday.
- The money is described as **supplemental funding** - extra cash on top of what these groups already get.
- It's not one or two programs - this touches **60 national sport organizations** at once.

The Debate Starter

- Should government be writing bigger checks to amateur sports, or is that cash better spent elsewhere - call in and make your case.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/national-sport-funding-federal-announcement-9.7391349?cmp=rss

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CANADIAN NEWS (4 stories)

■■ *One-on-one with former mayor Larry O'Brien*

The Angle: *A former mayor stepping back into the spotlight always invites some political retrospective — hosts can dig into what he's up to now and how he reflects on his time in office.*

The Debate Starter

- What do you actually remember about O'Brien's time as mayor — good, bad, or forgettable?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMikwFBVV95cUxOQ003UVJVbHhhQnkzTFNQSnpIRi1NeE9ZV1ktSVEzNUkta3pJVUF6S0VUTHVLT0oxQ21Wc0diMENGZjZWZ3BDLU15bmNwWXVqdFdEdlExSVo1eF9MTXJHQWs4QVE5QmhPalRTQmV1NmJYbDlYTWJzMFRTelRlQnNpeDhIa084bVVqMU1XWU1fUjJvNWc?oc=5

■ *Bill Clinton praises PM Carney, says Trump has treated Canada like 'dirt'*

The Angle: *A former U.S. President publicly siding with Canada against the current administration is a rare cross-border jab, and it taps right into the ongoing tension Canadians are feeling about how Trump talks about the country.*

- **Bill Clinton** praised Canadian **PM Mark Carney** in new comments
- Clinton says **Trump** has treated Canada like **'dirt'**
- Comes amid ongoing friction between the **Trump administration** and Canada

The Debate Starter

- Does it actually mean something when a former U.S. President stands up for Canada, or is it just politics as usual?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/world/trumps-tariffs/article/bill-clinton-calls-pm-carney-a-longtime-friend-says-us-treated-canada-like-dirt/

■ *Albertans want more control over immigration and limits on newcomers' access to social services*

The Angle: *A growing push in Alberta wants the province, not Ottawa, deciding who comes in and how fast newcomers can tap into social services - tapping straight into the national fight over who controls immigration in Canada.*

- **Albertans** are reportedly rallying behind the idea of more **provincial control** over immigration decisions rather than leaving it entirely to the **federal government**.
- Part of the push includes **limiting newcomers' access to social services** right away, instead of granting it immediately upon arrival.
- It plugs into the bigger, ongoing **national debate** over immigration levels and who should set the rules - Ottawa or the provinces.

The Debate Starter

- Should provinces get to set their own immigration rules, or does that just create a patchwork Canada depending on where you land?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nationalpost.com/news/canada/alberta-referendum-results-immigration

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■ *He bought a used SUV from a Volvo dealer. He regrets trusting their inspection process*

The Angle: *It's the classic 'buyer beware' nightmare — a certified pre-owned inspection is supposed to mean peace of mind, and this guy says it meant nothing. Anyone who's ever bought a used car will feel this one in their gut.*

- **Ashton-Vitaly Evdosin**, a **21-year-old student**, bought a **certified pre-owned Volvo** last fall
- He says he's had **continuous problems** with the vehicle ever since
- **None of the issues** were flagged in the **dealership's inspection report**
- He's now asking **Volvo Canada** to **cancel the sale** and give him a **full refund**

The Phone-In Trigger

- Ever bought a 'certified' used car that turned out to be anything but — what happened and did you ever get your money back?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/certified-pre-owned-volvo-problems-9.7388134?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *MPs moving to restrict gambling ads in Canada amid mounting harms*

The Angle: *If you've watched a hockey or basketball game lately and felt like every other break was a betting ad, you're not imagining it - a new CBC analysis backs that up, and now lawmakers are moving to actually do something about it.*

- A new analysis done **for CBC News** finds Canadians are getting **bombarded** with betting promotions during sports broadcasts.
- **MPs** are now moving to **restrict gambling ads** in Canada.
- The push comes amid what's being called **mounting harms** tied to gambling advertising saturation.

The Debate Starter

- Should betting ads get pulled from game broadcasts, or is this government overreach into how leagues and networks make their money?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/investigates/gambling-ads-restrictions-canada-9.7388888?cmp=rss

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■■ *Carney walks a trade, defence and diplomatic tightrope in Turkey*

The Angle: *Carney's courting a key NATO ally on trade and defence while Canada scrambles to not be so dependent on the US - but he's also got to tiptoe around Turkey's human rights record without blowing up the trip.*

- **Mark Carney** landed in **Turkey** on **Thursday** for what's being called a historic visit
- The goal: boost **trade and defence co-operation** with Turkey, a key **NATO** ally
- It's part of **Ottawa's** push to diversify trade beyond the **United States**
- Carney has to navigate touchy questions about **Ankara's crackdown on civil society groups**

The Debate Starter

- Is it smart diplomacy to deepen ties with a country cracking down on civil rights, or does 'diversify from the US' mean anything-goes right now?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/turkey-defence-human-rights-trade-9.7391275?cmp=rss

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■■ *Danielle Smith draws line in the sand for UCP members following Alberta referendum*

The Angle: *Alberta's premier is reportedly laying down new rules for her own UCP members in the wake of the province's referendum — internal party drama is always a watercooler draw, especially when it's a premier versus her own caucus.*

- **Danielle Smith**, Alberta's premier, is setting firm new expectations for **UCP** members.
- The move comes directly on the heels of a provincial referendum in **Alberta**.
- Framed as a 'line in the sand' — signaling real tension within her own party.

The Debate Starter

- Is Danielle Smith uniting her party after the vote, or picking a fight with her own members?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi0wFBVV95cUxQWjVOSHpXXzRJRDVhZzZsQWxxanpOMm01dF9sLUxPTmt6SmFSRjdjVWhXWUJjWDJuMUg5ZUhxbmpHRU43aHNvVjJDa3hNcXRFbEJnVGNJUjBwcEx5TFZoQURrZENLbzB2WGJvTjV3V2tzdGx6dXUwZUxDOFY1N2Y1M1JLS24wZGtMaXZDb3JnenNYaXdRd1FDbTZWUFVPZV9ZNHRkS2hucUhoN3RMbkdzNzI1SHFrZXo1OVNzTkdlSGxyR3A3TUg3NzF1UVRYVnpfekJV?oc=5

■ *Federal union announces strike vote for 120,000 public service workers*

The Angle: *A strike vote covering that many public service workers isn't just a labor story — it's a preview of possible disruptions to federal services Canadians rely on every day.*

- A federal union has announced a **strike vote** covering roughly **120,000 public service workers**.
- This is a vote to authorize a strike, not a confirmed walkout yet.

The Debate Starter

- If 120,000 federal workers walk out, which government service would you miss first?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirgFBVV95cUxPVHJ4YzlCUFN3VTl2N3lIb1VIY29HMGlTM2VpNy1ELVRfT2VQTU9QTHlIOExEcXl1ZGpaczM4YzVVSGRPUGVDOFNzbk1nUHRxUjl0SFlheWFVQVBuVjBrYno0WkFobE5aS1R2NEJqbFJNQTdVR3FyMGJBSzhld1hMaG9mcHp6d3BvOXJrcUhrMEFrUldhbXloQTBZdktFN1dwRTlRUlBpRFNENm1xQVE?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (5 stories)

■ *Travis Knight says 'AI Is not a tool. AI can go fuck itself'*

The Angle: *A major animation studio chief going full scorched-earth on AI isn't just spicy quote fodder - it's the clearest shot yet in Hollywood's ongoing fight over AI replacing artists, and it's got people picking sides online.*

- **Travis Knight**, CEO of stop-motion studio **Laika** (Kubo and the Two Strings, Coraline), went viral for the line: "**AI is not a tool. AI can go f*** itself.**"
- The quote is being read as a direct shot at the entertainment industry's growing use of AI in animation and filmmaking.
- It's landing hard on **Reddit's r/entertainment**, fueling the ongoing artists-vs-AI debate in Hollywood.

The Debate Starter

- Is AI a helpful tool for creatives or a threat that deserves zero benefit of the doubt - where do you land?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://popculturenews.com/travis-knight-says-ai-is-not-a-tool-ai-can-go-fuck-itself/

■ *Mahershala Ali: 'I'm finally an action hero at age 52'*

The Angle: *The two-time Oscar winner known for prestige drama is pivoting hard into action - a late-career swing that's a fun 'it's never too late' story and a great excuse to debate Hollywood's obsession with youth.*

- **Mahershala Ali** - two-time Oscar winner (**Moonlight**, **Green Book**) - says he's **'finally an action hero'** at age **52**
- Marks a notable genre pivot for an actor best known for prestige drama and awards-season roles

The Debate Starter

- Is 52 the new action-hero prime, or is Hollywood just finally letting older stars throw a punch?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://metro.co.uk/2026/10/21/mahershala-ali-im-finally-action-hero-age-52-29721858/

■ *After a recent taping of Subway Takes, a woman sits down and proceeds to riff with Conan O'Brien (a notoriously great improviser), matching him joke for joke to his complete delight*

The Angle: *A comedy legend known for lightning-fast improv gets matched punchline-for-punchline by a total stranger on Subway Takes, and the clip is blowing up because nobody expected the civilian to win the exchange.*

The Clip Check

- Ever gone joke-for-joke with someone way funnier than you and actually held your own?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Set the Scene** - 30 seconds -> Describe the Subway Takes setup and tee up that Conan is famous for out-improvising guests — then flip it: this time he got matched.
- **Step 2: Play the Clip** - 1 minute -> Pull the clip from r/fauxmoi/Subway Takes and play the exchange so listeners hear the actual back-and-forth.
- **Step 3: Hosts Joke-Battle** - 2 minutes -> Hosts do a quick rapid-fire 'top this joke' round with each other or a caller to see who can keep a straight face longest.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/te3saeuznuwh1

■■ *Dolly Parton's Sister Says Her Ballot Kept Switching to Another Candidate While Voting Early in Tennessee*

The Angle: *Dolly Parton's name alone gets ears perked up, and a family member claiming her early ballot in Tennessee kept switching candidates taps straight into the election-integrity anxiety everyone's already primed for right now.*

- **Dolly Parton's sister** says she experienced an issue while **voting early in Tennessee**.
- She claims her ballot selection **kept switching to a different candidate** than the one she picked.
- The story is circulating via **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, tying a celebrity family name to a voting-machine complaint.

The Debate Starter

- Glitch, user error, or something hosts should be worried about — have you ever had your ballot or screen not register your actual pick?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://parade.com/news/dolly-parton-sister-stella-parton-ballot-switching-votes-tennessee-early-voting

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■ *Lord of the Flies reimagined for TV as a darker, more intimate take on the classic novel*

The Angle: *Lord of the Flies reimagined for TV as a darker, more intimate take on the classic novel*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/lord-of-the-flies-miniseries-adaptation-9.7384113?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Who Is Clayface? What Is He Doing in the First Batman-Related Movie of the DCU?*

The Angle: *James Gunn is kicking off the DCU's first Gotham story not with Joker or Penguin, but with Clayface — a shapeshifting B-lister — and that gamble says a lot about where this new superhero universe is headed.*

- **James Gunn** is producing the DCU's first **Gotham City-set** story
- The villain chosen is **Clayface**, a lesser-known name from Batman's rogues gallery
- The pick breaks from the usual go-to villains (Joker, Penguin, Riddler) fans expect

The Debate Starter

- Bold move or buried lede — should superhero movies finally ditch the household-name villains?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/10/22/who-is-clayface-what-is-the-clayface-movie-about/

■■ *Jessie James Decker and Eric's kids flaunt matching 'washboard' abs in beach photos*

The Angle: *It's peak celebrity-parent flex content — a former NFL player and a country-pop star showing off their kids' six-packs on a beach vacation is exactly the kind of harmless, relatable "wait, are my kids in better shape than me" bait that gets a studio laughing.*

- **Jessie James Decker** and husband **Eric Decker**, the former NFL receiver, posted a joint Instagram over the weekend
- The post shows their **family of five** on fall break in **Florida**
- The kids are shown flaunting matching **"washboard" abs** in the beach photos

The Debate Starter

- Harmless family flex or a little much to show off your kids' abs online — where's the line?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/22/celebrity-news/jessie-james-decker-and-erics-kids-flaunt-matching-abs-in-beach-photos/

■■ *Connie Britton Is People Talks' Latest Guest, Plus Julianne Moore, Dakota Johnson and More - People.com*

The Angle: *People's recurring 'People Talks' interview franchise just dropped a fresh round of A-list guests, giving us an easy excuse to dish on who's saying what and teeing up a few names worth watching this week.*

- **Connie Britton** is the latest guest featured in **People**'s **'People Talks'** interview series
- The same roundup also includes **Julianne Moore** and **Dakota Johnson**
- It's part of an ongoing **People.com** franchise that rotates through notable actors for quick sit-down chats

The Fan Pick

- Of those three — Connie Britton, Julianne Moore, or Dakota Johnson — whose interview would you actually click on first?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMioAFBVV95cUxNX2h6R2NmVkQyakNmRG5nT3IxRmhsclY0SEpoblE4SUF3U0FFdmhuYWExNmtCSVQtWnZLbk1NbHNCMG1Pa2xsVVJtOWE3b1RKVmk5b25SN1NzSVBmV0UySDF6TEJXaDR4RHVKTFhhYmJsQUJyTzRSV29xXzJfaTEyaWRhZHVFTk1ITFhBbFE3YzA2Y0xYWTlfVGNlbGRpVFhj?oc=5

■ *'Glee' Reboot Officially Set at Disney+ and Hulu - Variety*

The Angle: *Ryan Murphy's gleefully chaotic musical dramedy is getting a reboot, and that's instant nostalgia bait for a whole generation that grew up on Sue Sylvester takedowns and mash-up covers.*

- **Disney+** and **Hulu** have officially ordered a reboot of **Glee**
- The original series comes from **Ryan Murphy**, who's calling it both "famous" and "infamous"
- Even the announcement leaned into the show's own cheesy DNA, quoting Finn Hudson: "the show must go all over the place, or something"

The Nostalgia Trigger

- Who's your dream cast for a new Glee — bring back original characters or start from scratch with new kids at McKinley?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/glee-reboot-disney-hulu-1236918160/

■ *Julia Stiles Reunites With '10 Things I Hate About You' Cast to Honor Heath Ledger on 'DWTS' - The Hollywood Reporter*

The Angle: *A surprise cast reunion honoring Heath Ledger always hits an emotional nerve, and pairing it with a beloved rom-com's most iconic love-interest moment is pure nostalgia bait for anyone who grew up on that movie.*

- **Julia Stiles** and pro partner **Ezra Sosa** danced to **"Can't Take My Eyes Off You"** on Tuesday's episode
- The **10 Things I Hate About You** cast reunited on **Dancing with the Stars**
- The tribute honored the late **Heath Ledger**, who starred in the 1999 film

The Nostalgia Trigger

- What's the one 90s/2000s rom-com you still can't watch without tearing up?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/julia-stiles-reunites-10-things-i-hate-about-you-cast-heath-ledger-dwts-1236737039/

TRENDING TODAY

■■ *'Woke nonsense': Museum slammed for 'stupidity and ignorance' after removing mummy over its lack of consent*

The Angle: *A museum yanking an ancient mummy because it supposedly can't give consent is pure watercooler bait — it's the kind of culture-war flashpoint that gets instant reaction, with critics already blasting it as peak 'woke' overreach.*

The Debate Starter

- Is pulling the mummy basic respect for human remains, or performative nonsense that guts a museum's whole purpose?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/22/science/mummies-removed-from-scotland-museum-due-to-lack-of-consent/

Backup options:

■ *New York congressional candidate Brad Lander says he was detained by IDF in the occupied West Bank - NBC News*

The Angle: *A sitting NYC political figure running for Congress claims he was detained by the IDF in the West Bank — that's a politician-meets-geopolitics story that's guaranteed to spark a reaction on both sides of the Israel-Palestine debate.*

- **Brad Lander**, a **New York congressional candidate**, says he was detained by the **Israel Defense Forces** in the **occupied West Bank**
- He says it happened while he was taking part in an **olive harvest**
- Lander broke the news himself, posting about it on **X** on **Wednesday**

The Debate Starter

- Does a U.S. political candidate getting detained overseas change how you see the Israel-Palestine story, or is this just a campaign moment?

NBC News (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nbcnews.com/politics/politics-news/new-york-congressional-candidate-brad-lander-detained-west-bank-rcna604741

■ *Nvidia CEO Huang Pitches Europe on All Industries Adopting AI - Bloomberg.com*

The Angle: *The world's most valuable chipmaker's boss is out there playing AI hype-man even as Wall Street starts side-eyeing the trillions being dumped into AI infrastructure - it's a window into whether this boom is real or a bubble everyone's quietly nervous about.*

- **Jensen Huang**, CEO of **Nvidia**, is urging Europe to speed up AI adoption
- He's striking a **bullish tone** on AI's future despite growing investor skepticism
- Some investors are getting nervous about the **massive sums poured into AI infrastructure**

The Debate Starter

- Is AI the next internet-level boom, or are we all about to find out it was a very expensive bubble?

Bloomberg (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-10-21/nvidia-ceo-huang-pitches-europe-on-all-industries-adopting-ai

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *At 100 and losing his eyesight, a WWII veteran is still handmaking wooden cars for children overseas he'll never meet. He's made over 1,000 in a decade, including more than 100 this year for Operation Christmas Child, and hopes to keep going another 10 years.*

The Angle: *This is the ultimate feel-good watercooler story - a century-old veteran who's losing his eyesight is still grinding away at his workbench for kids he will literally never meet. It's the kind of pure-generosity story that makes people stop scrolling.*

- He's **100 years old**, a **WWII veteran**, and he's losing his eyesight - but he's still at the workbench.
- He's handcrafted over **1,000 wooden cars** in the last **decade** for kids overseas.
- More than **100 cars this year alone**, all donated through **Operation Christmas Child**.
- His plan: keep carving for **another 10 years** - he'll never meet a single kid who gets one.

The Heart-Check

- A 100-year-old losing his sight is still making gifts for strangers he'll never meet - what's your excuse today?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kplctv.com/2026/10/03/100-sulphur-man-still-building-toy-cars-children-overseas-hell-never-meet/

Backup options:

■ *A couple's 36 hour train ride home with their quintuplets became a community effort: railway staff carried luggage and moved them to a lower berth, while fellow passengers took turns feeding, holding and soothing the five babies so the parents could rest.*

The Angle: *A couple traveling home with five babies turned total strangers into a tag-team support crew - it's the kind of pure, feel-good human interest story that makes for easy, warm chat on a slow news day.*

- The train ride lasted **36 hours** with the couple's **quintuplets** in tow

- **Railway staff** carried luggage and moved the family to a **lower berth** for easier access
- **Fellow passengers** took turns **feeding, holding, and soothing** the five babies
- The help let the exhausted parents actually **rest** during the long trip

The Feel-Good Follow-Up

- Have you ever had total strangers step up to help you out on a flight or train ride - what happened?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://amp.scmp.com/news/people-culture/trending-china/article/3371231/strangers-and-railway-staff-help-chinese-couple-bring-quintuplets-home-train

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■ *1 in 3 American boys aged 13 to 17 follows Andrew Tate at least a little, and those who do are more likely to believe men should hide their emotions, be dominant and reject anything feminine. But the strongest predictor wasn't Tate at all - it was parents telling their sons to be big and tough.*

The Angle: *A third of American teen boys are tuning into Andrew Tate, and it's shaping how they think men should act - but the study says the bigger influence is actually parents telling their sons to 'be tough.' That twist flips the usual blame-the-internet story on its head.*

- **1 in 3** American boys aged **13 to 17** say they follow **Andrew Tate** at least a little
- Those boys are more likely to believe men should **hide their emotions**, be **dominant**, and **reject anything feminine**
- The **strongest predictor** of those beliefs wasn't Tate at all - it was **parents telling their sons to be big and tough**

The Debate Starter

- Is Andrew Tate really the problem, or are we just raising boys the same way our parents did and blaming the internet for it?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.psypost.org/one-in-three-teen-boys-follows-andrew-tate-at-least-a-little-and-those-who-do-hold-more-rigid-views-of-manhood/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■■ *Texas's 5 Biggest Counties Blow Early Voting Records Out of the Water*

The Angle: *Turnout surges like this are the kind of thing that gets people talking about what's actually driving voters to the polls early — and it's a feel-good sign of civic engagement right before an election.*

- Texas's **five biggest counties** have already blown past their previous **early voting records**
- The surge signals unusually high civic engagement heading into this election

The Takeaway

- Record early voting in the state's biggest counties is a reminder that no matter which side you're on, more people showing up to vote is a genuine good-news story.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://newrepublic.com/post/216873/texas-5-biggest-counties-early-voting-records

Backup options:

■ *In 2004, Steve and Terri Irwin Transformed an Avocado Shed into an Animal Hospital that Has Helped Over 136,000 Animals*

The Angle: *Steve and Terri Irwin turned a literal fruit shed into a wildlife hospital back in 2004, and two decades later it's quietly become one of the great animal-rescue stories out there - a perfect feel-good closer about*

legacy and what a small idea can grow into.

- Back in **2004**, **Steve and Terri Irwin** converted an old **avocado shed** into an animal hospital.
- That hospital has now treated more than **136,000 animals**.
- It's a living piece of **Steve Irwin's** legacy, still running strong years after his passing.

The Feel-Good Finisher

- A fruit shed turned into a hospital that's saved over 136,000 animals - proof the best legacies start small.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/steve-irwin-terri-irwin-transformed-old-avocado-shed-into-wildlife-hospital-12183178

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 4/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Talarico wants TMZ to host his debate with Paxton. Seriously.*

The Angle: *A Texas political debate getting pitched to TMZ instead of a normal news outlet is the kind of mash-up that writes its own punchline, and it taps into a real debate about how political theater and tabloid media are blending together.*

- **James Talarico** reportedly wants **TMZ** to host his debate against **Ken Paxton**
- The pairing of hardball Texas politics with a celebrity gossip outlet is the whole joke here
- Even the headline writers couldn't resist the "seriously?" reaction

The Head-Scratcher

- Would you actually tune in if TMZ ran a political debate?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.chron.com/news/article/james-talarico-ken-paxton-tmz-22487596.php

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■ *'Because We Showed Our Nipples': MMA Fighter Reveals Huge OnlyFans Payday After Nip Slip on Live TV*

The Angle: *A wardrobe malfunction on live television usually means embarrassment — this MMA fighter turned it into a massive payday, and she's bluntly explaining why on the record. Perfect weird-news kicker material.*

- An **MMA fighter** says a live TV **"nip slip"** led directly to a **huge OnlyFans payday**.
- Her own quote on the cash-in: **"Because we showed our nipples."**
- Story's already blowing up on **r/nottheonion** for how blunt the explanation is.

The Debate Starter

- Smart hustle or just thirst-trap opportunism — would you cash in on your own on-air wardrobe malfunction?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/lucero-acosta-onlyfans-payday-pfl-wardrobe-malfunction-1766100

■ *Vance says Republicans shouldn't complain about Ramaswamy ad featuring Amy Acton's estranged mother*

The Angle: *A sitting VP publicly defending a campaign ad that drags a candidate's estranged mother into the mud is exactly the kind of political-ick, watercooler-bait story that lands in the 'you can't make this up' file.*

- **JD Vance** publicly backed a **Ramaswamy** campaign ad
- The ad reportedly features **Amy Acton's estranged mother**
- **Vance** told fellow **Republicans** to stop complaining about it

The Debate Starter

- Is dragging a candidate's estranged family into an attack ad fair game, or is this the new low in political advertising?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/election-2026-ohio-governor-ramaswamy-acton-mother-93ab182c3e0a95d25ddb409ec0628231

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *After 44 years at Sorocaba Zoo, elephant Sandro has a new 13 acre sanctuary habitat. He used to spend 16 hours each night in a barn barely inches taller than he was, but on his second night in his new home, he chose to sleep outside under the stars.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Elephant-redemption narratives (44 years in a cramped barn to 13 acres) are a proven uplifting-news format that reliably outperforms its early vote count once shared widely.
The Angle: *It's the kind of simple, gut-punch good-news story that stops people mid-scroll — a massive animal denied space for decades finally gets room to just... be an elephant, and the internet can't get over it.*

- Elephant named **Sandro** spent **44 years** at **Sorocaba Zoo**
- He used to be cooped up **16 hours every night** in a barn barely taller than he was
- He was just moved to a brand-new **13-acre sanctuary habitat**
- On just his **second night** in the new space, he chose to sleep **outside under the stars**

The Feel-Good Moment

- What's the smallest freedom you'd miss most after 44 years without it?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/in-brazils-chapada-dos-guimaraes-asian-elephant-sandro-about-54-walked-out-of-a-crate-after-44-years-at-the-sorocaba-zoo-and-on-his-second-night-he-chose-to-sleep-outside-under-the-stars/52422/

■ *McDonald’s has a McHero: 11 year old Tristen Ewbank used what he learned from YouTube to save a six year old choking on a chicken nugget in the play area, patting the boy’s back until it came out while his grandmother was away getting milkshakes.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A named 11-year-old saving a choking child using YouTube-learned skills is a concrete, relatable hero story with a clean hook that tends to get picked up by local/national news aggregators after Reddit traction.
The Angle: *A pint-sized hero story out of a McDonald's play area - a kid saving a kid using nothing but YouTube know-how is exactly the feel-good, shareable moment that cuts through a heavy news day.*

- **Tristen Ewbank**, just **11 years old**, stepped in when a **6-year-old boy** started choking on a **chicken nugget**
- It happened in the **play area** of a **McDonald's**
- Tristen used a back-patting technique he **learned from YouTube** to clear it
- The boy's **grandmother** was away at the counter getting **milkshakes** when it happened

The Feel-Good Phone-In

- Would your kid know what to do if a stranger's kid started choking next to them?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.myjournalcourier.com/news/article/roodhouse-boy-choking-child-22460215.php

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■ *'I just wanted help': Mom of toddler found alive in hospital morgue questions doctor's decision*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The sheer shock-value absurdity of a living toddler found in a morgue is exactly the kind of jaw-dropping, shareable 'is this real' story that nottheonion content thrives on.
The Angle: *A bizarre, nightmare-fuel hospital story that taps straight into every parent's worst fear — a toddler mistakenly written off as dead, discovered alive, and a mom now publicly questioning the doctor's call.*

- The toddler's **mother** says she **"just wanted help"** when she brought her child in
- The child was reportedly found **alive** inside a **hospital morgue** after being presumed dead
- The mom is now publicly **questioning the doctor's decision** that led to the mix-up

The Debate Starter

- Would this make you ever trust a hospital's 'time of death' call again?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.abc15.com/news/local-news/investigations/i-just-wanted-help-mom-of-toddler-found-alive-in-hospital-morgue-questions-doctors-decision

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■ *South Texas House candidate Brandon Herrera says kittens should be sent to Chinese restaurants*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An actual political candidate publicly suggesting kittens be sent to Chinese restaurants is outrage-bait tailor-made for clip/quote virality during an active campaign.
The Angle: *A sitting congressional candidate joking about sending kittens to Chinese restaurants is the exact brand of tone-deaf that makes a perfect 'can you believe this guy' kicker story.*

- **Brandon Herrera** is running for a US House seat in **South Texas**
- He's quoted suggesting kittens should be sent to **Chinese restaurants**
- The remark is circulating widely on **Reddit's r/nottheonion**, the subreddit for real stories too absurd to believe

The Groan Line

- Bad joke, bad candidate, or both - does a comment like this actually cost a politician votes anymore?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sacurrent.com/news/texas-news/south-texas-house-candidate-brandon-herrera-says-kittens-should-be-sent-to-chinese-restaurants/

■ *Paul Mescal, Jessie Buckley and more major names defend Sally Rooney against "draconian" Palestine Action ban*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Paul Mescal and Jessie Buckley's star power colliding with the Sally Rooney/Palestine Action ban controversy gives this both celebrity pull and a live political flashpoint to ride.
The Angle: *Normal People's Paul Mescal and Jessie Buckley are among a wave of major names publicly backing Sally Rooney after the UK's Palestine Action ban put the bestselling author in legal jeopardy — a celebrity-meets-politics flashpoint that's impossible not to react to.*

- **Paul Mescal** and **Jessie Buckley** are among the major names publicly defending **Sally Rooney**
- The backlash centers on the UK's ban on **Palestine Action**, which stars are calling "**draconian**"
- Rooney is the acclaimed author behind **Normal People** and **Conversations with Friends**

The Debate Starter

- Should A-list celebrities be weighing in on government bans like this, or should they stay out of politics entirely?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://faroutmagazine.co.uk/paul-mescal-jessie-buckleydefend-sally-rooney-against-draconian-palestine-action-ban/

■■ *Dame Judi Dench, 91, reveals she cannot act on stage or in films or read a book as she battles eye condition*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A beloved 91-year-old legend like Judi Dench revealing she can no longer act or read due to an eye condition is a poignant, big-name health story with strong emotional resonance and tribute-driven sharing.
The Angle: *One of the most beloved actresses alive just revealed her eyesight has gotten so bad she can't act on stage, can't act on film, and can't even read a book anymore - it's a gut-punch moment for anyone who grew up watching her.*

- **Dame Judi Dench**, now **91**, says she's no longer able to act on stage
- She also says she can't act in films anymore because of her eye condition
- The legendary actress revealed she can't even **read a book** these days

The Human Moment

- If you woke up tomorrow and couldn't read or watch a movie ever again, what would you miss the most?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.dailymail.com/news/article-16228875/Dame-Judi-Dench-act-stage-films-read-book-eye-condition.html

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FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Claude Allegedly Let a Digital Grandma Die Rather Than Recite Justin Bieber Lyrics in a Bizarre AI Test" (Reddit r/nottheonion, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Dan Quinn ‘definitely knew it was 4th down’ after lip readers questioned Commanders bizarre play" (nypost.com, banked 2026-10-20)
- "HUNTER: Hug-a-thug judges hit daily double of bizarre decisions" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-10-20)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)
- "A top QB showdown and a historic anniversary: 5 things to know from the NFL this week - CNN" (CNN (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-02)
- "Banjo-Kazooie PC port developer blasts AI vibe coding as retro gaming fills with low-quality ports" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-07)
- "30 of the Most Fool-Proof (and Romantic) Anniversary Gifts for Him" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "The Atari 800XL is back as a $220 retro machine with a real keyboard, HDMI, and a working cartridge slot" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "‘Three Days Of Rain’ Broadway Revival With François Arnaud, David Corenswet & Yvonne Strahovski Sets Opening Date, Venue" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the ‘Girls’ Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the 'Girls' Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea https://t.co/lTSfPsejyB" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-13)
- "London society frets as King Charles skips major high-culture event" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo and Chappell Roan Compete on Game Shows Hosted by David Byrne in the Retro Video for 'Expectations' Remix https://t.co/sBX7jh" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo Taps Chappell Roan (and David Byrne) for Retro ‘Expectations’ Remix" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Seahawks vs. Broncos, ‘Thursday Night Football’ game chat and live discussion - Field Gulls" (Field Gulls (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-16)
- "Iron Maiden Announce Surprise 2027 North American Tour" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-18)
- "‘Other Desert Cities’ Theater Review: Julia Louis-Dreyfus, Ed Harris and Allison Janney Fail to Make a Once-Timely Play Relevant Again" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Says She’s Returning for Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival: ‘I Would Do Anything for Her’" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Teases Return In Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival On HBO: “I Would Do Anything For Her”" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)

- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-21)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 4 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-10-22 09:43 AM